bringing academic institutions into such roles on the grounds of better abilities in working with evidence and concepts of public economics, and on the grounds of a more dispassionate and evidence-based approach.

Increasing analytical capability in government

Level I: At its best, an Indian government organization should be imbued with analytical capabilities. It should be able to utilize evidence to conduct research and utilize this for the policy process. This would then be comparable to the best-policy organizations seen in mature market economies, where the internal staff have research capabilities and are able to produce high-quality work. Once research capabilities inside the government organization are adequate, the knowledge institutions of society contribute to the policy process through research products that they release into the public domain (which are utilized by government employees), through criticism of the status quo, and through participation in the public debate about reforms. This is the destination that we should aspire for in India, which is many years away.

Level II: The second best path is one where the Indian government organization lacks these capabilities, but is able to forge deep partnerships with research institutions. Through this, evidence and research would be brought into the innermost discussions about policymaking.

Level III: The weakest path is that of a conventional Indian policy institution, which lacks a research culture, and lacks deep partnerships with research institutions. The lack of knowledge partnerships comes about either owing to lack of interest in ideas, or from the insistence that academic institutions must be subservient to government officials. Such policy institutions produce the lowest-quality work in the policy process.